



Promote tourism products and services

D2.TCS.CL5.21

Assessor Manual



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Project Base

William Angliss Institute of TAFE
555 La Trobe Street
Melbourne 3000 Victoria

Telephone: (03) 9606 2111
Facsimile: (03) 9670 1330

Acknowledgements

Project Director:	Wayne Crosbie
Project Manager	Jim Irwin
Chief Writer:	Alan Hickman
Subject Writer:	Nick Hyland
Editor:	Jim Irwin
DTP/Production:	Daniel Chee, Mai Vu, Cindy Curran

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Table of contents

Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors.....	1
Competency standard.....	11
Oral questions.....	25
Written questions	35
Answers to written questions	43
Observation checklist.....	53
Third Party Statement.....	57
Competency recording sheet	61

Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested Assessment Methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes

- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of Assessment Methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing Competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of Practice for Assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes

- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and Checklist for Assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing Checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

Prior to the assessment I have:	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for Recording Competency

Specifications for Recording Competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for Different Assessment Methods

Specifications for Work Project Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):

“At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.

These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:

 - You are required to complete these activities:
 - Using the 'X' method of assessment*
 - At 'X' location*
 - You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
 - You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
 - Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- Commence Work Project assessment:
 - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
 - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
 - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
 - Enter Student name
 - Enter Assessor name
 - Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):

“These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.

We have 60 minutes for this assessment.

- I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
 - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
 - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
 - b) Entering ‘Remarks’ as required
 - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of ‘Written Questions’ for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a ‘X’ is identified, please input appropriate information):

“These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
 - Pass Competent = Yes
 - Not Yet Competent = No
 - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: PROMOTE TOURISM PRODUCTS AND SERVICES		NOMINAL HOURS: 60
UNIT NUMBER: D2.TCS.CL5.21		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with skills and knowledge required to identify customer needs and respond appropriately by identifying and encouraging the purchase of suitable tourism products and services		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA	UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE	
Element 1: Develop tourism produce and services knowledge 1.1 Identify <i>opportunities to develop tourism product and service knowledge</i> 1.2 Describe the <i>benefits of staff having high levels of product and service knowledge</i> 1.3 Apply <i>formal and informal research techniques</i> to gain product and service knowledge 1.4 Seek <i>customer feedback</i> to supplement product and service knowledge 1.5 Share <i>product and service knowledge</i> with other relevant internal personnel 1.6 Contribute to <i>changes to tourism products, services and service standards</i> to meet identified customer need	Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment. This unit applies to the promotion and selling of tourism products and services to customers within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Travel Agencies 2. Tour Operation <i>Opportunities to develop tourism product and service knowledge</i> may be related to: • Personal experience • Reading informational brochures and other materials provided by suppliers, providers and carriers • Reading brochures and marketing materials including items for public consumption and restricted access materials designed solely for industry operators • Attending product launches	

Element 2: Develop tourism market knowledge 2.1 Explain <i>the concept of target markets</i> 2.2 Define <i>the concept of niche markets</i> 2.3 Describe <i>how promotions and offers may vary to suit differing target markets</i> 2.4 Identify <i>sources of information about enterprise-specific target markets</i> 2.5 Describe the <i>demographic characteristics of enterprise target markets</i> 2.6 Initiate <i>action to identify changes in customer preferences, needs, wants and expectations</i> 2.7 Explain the <i>benefits of using target markets</i> within an organisation Element 3: Identify individual customer needs 3.1 Interpret <i>statements made by customers</i> 3.2 Ask <i>questions to determine requirements</i> 3.3 Consider the <i>buying history of the customer</i> 3.4 Establish <i>buying parameters</i> Element 4: Promote tourism products and services 4.1 Describe <i>promotional initiatives</i> that may be used to promote tourism products	• Visiting suppliers, providers and carriers • Talking to sales representatives and agency representatives. <i>Benefits of sales staff having high levels of product and service knowledge will include:</i> • Being able to provide professional assistance to customers • Being able to distinguish between alternatives • Meeting customer expectations • Maximising selling opportunities • Being better able to meet and overcome buying objections. <i>Product and service knowledge must include all tourism-related products and services provided by the host enterprise and may include:</i> • Tours, trips, travel and transfers including all types of travel, rates, fares, schedules and travel insurance • Special deals and packages • Conferences, conventions, events and meetings including use of function and entertainment facilities, venue bookings and availability of associated equipment and services • Natural and built attractions • Accommodation and dining including large-scale catering, where applicable • Shopping facilities at destinations including retail shops in properties. <i>Formal and informal research techniques may include:</i> • Discussions with colleagues, management and customers • Reading internal enterprise material about tourism products and services • Becoming familiar with customer comments and feedback including complaints
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4.2 Demonstrate how to develop and produce a <i>static in-house promotion</i> 4.3 <i>Verbally promote tourism products and/or services to customers</i> Element 5: Apply selling skills 5.1 <i>Approach the customer in a sales environment</i> 5.2 <i>Gather information about customer needs, wants and preferences</i> 5.3 <i>Demonstrate selling skills</i> 5.4 <i>Overcome buying objections</i> 5.5 <i>Maximise sales opportunities within a buying situation</i> 5.6 <i>Close the sale</i>	• Reading product and services information sheets provided by suppliers, providers and carriers • Comparing similar tourism products and services to identify points of difference • General media research • Developing, distributing and analysing responses to questionnaires • Reading surveys and ratings undertaken by industry third parties. <i>Customer feedback</i> should include: • Developing, distributing and analysing the responses to questionnaires • Talking to customers and actively seeking their opinion and thoughts on tourism products and services they have considered and/or purchased • Checking internal buying patterns and trends of customers. <i>Share product and service knowledge</i> should relate to: • Conducting internal staff meetings to share information • Developing paper-based information and data sheets for staff use • Allowing staff to experience tourism products and services provided by the organisation, where appropriate. <i>Contribute to changes to tourism products, services and service standards</i> may involve: • Suggesting evidence-based reasons for change • Preparing presentations to support personal recommendations for change • Ensuring all suggestions for change are supported by a formal rationale and are fully costed • Developing an action plan for implementing recommended changes • Participating in group activities designed to identify and develop relevant changes • Critiquing suggestions made by others.
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	<i>The concept of target markets</i> may relate to: • Identifying target markets used by the host enterprise • Identifying points of differentiation between established target markets • Describing why the established target markets were chosen • Explaining how the host enterprise tailors its tourism products and/or services to meet the identified needs of its target markets • Identifying relevant tourism products and/or services as they apply to each of the host enterprise's designated target markets • Analysing market research used as the basis for target market development. <i>The concept of niche markets</i> should include: • Definition of niche markets • Benefits of identifying and establishing niche markets • Identifying the niche markets the host enterprise has created and/or established • Identifying how the host enterprise meets the identified needs of their niche markets explaining how these offerings differ from what is offered to other target markets. <i>Describe how promotions and offers may vary</i> may relate to: • Considering the marketing mix price, place, product, promotion • Identifying the development and research process that underpins offers made and packages developed for different target markets • Identifying the monitoring process and relevant Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) that determine whether promotions are being effective or not. <i>Sources of information about enterprise-specific target markets</i> may include: • Internal historic records such as bookings and sales records, customer purchase histories and customer databases
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	• Customer market research • Information from support businesses such as suppliers, providers, carriers, agents, associates, head office and industry peak bodies • Customer feedback, paper-based, electronic/on-line, verbal feedback, customer complaints and comments. <i>Demographic characteristics may relate to:</i> • Age • Gender • Marital status including details of family • Identifying the nature and size of the buying unit company, individual, agent, wholesale, retail, government, domestic and international • Earning level and/or level of disposable income • Access to credit • Ethnicity and language spoken • Geographic location • Employment type and status • Transport used • Media used • Preferred buying/payment option. <i>Initiate action to identify changes may include:</i> • Undertaking market research activities • Engaging the services of an external market research company
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	• Tracking trends and changes in internal sales patterns within the enterprise with reference to customer databases, bookings and/or sales • Initiating customer focus groups or similar • Participating in industry-wide surveys • Obtaining, reading and understanding wider industry market research on changes in customer preferences. <i>Benefits of using target markets may relate to:</i> • Being better able to meet identified need • Increased, faster and more profitable sales • More satisfied customers • Ability to become established as a specialist organisation for nominated tourism products and services • Enhanced levels of repeat and referral business from satisfied niche market customers • Being able to get to know the target market better as the level of interaction with them builds • Reducing the likelihood of competitors entering into the marketplace. <i>Interpret statements should include:</i> • Listening to verbal descriptions, aspirations and requests • Paying attention to non-verbal cues that accompany verbal language • Reading material supplied by the customer • Reading 'between the lines' • Applying reflective and active listening techniques.
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	<i>Ask questions</i> should relate to: • Applying open and closed questioning techniques • Refining options available through the use of questioning • Using reflective questioning techniques • Paraphrasing customer statements • Seeking additional information • Confirming previously received messages. <i>Consider the buying history</i> may include: • Seeking information from the customer about their travel and tourism experiences • Reviewing client history files • Reviewing customer complaints and compliments, where applicable. <i>Buying parameters</i> may include: • Timing • Budget • Individual needs, wants and preferences for suppliers, providers and carriers • Negotiable and non-negotiable elements of the proposed purchase. <i>Promotional initiatives</i> may relate to: • Media campaigns • Internal promotions such as static displays, videos, competitions, celebrity appearances, 'specials' and packages. <i>Static in-house promotion</i> may include: • Window and counter displays including pricing tickets and itineraries
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	• Use of point-of-sale material provided by suppliers, providers and carriers • Advertising material that promotes nominated tourism products and/or services • Informational and other print-based materials including posters • Use of appropriate props to support, extend and highlight the tourism product and/or service being promoted • Integration with external media and other campaigns. <i>Verbally promoting tourism products and/or services</i> must include: • Honesty and accuracy in descriptions • Adherence to enterprise policies and procedures governing selling • Using appropriate questioning and listening techniques • Using descriptive phrases • Selling the benefits and not the features • Comparison of various tourism products and services • Making suggestions and recommendations • Meeting identified customer need • Using brochures and marketing materials to supplement and illustrate the verbal explanation. <i>Approach the customer</i> may relate to over-the-telephone and face-to-face situations and may include: • Determining and applying appropriate timing of the approach • Greeting and welcoming the customer • Identifying self and making an offer of assistance
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	• Identifying and applying the preferred sales approach given the factors that apply at the time • Creating and conveying a positive impression to arouse and/or sustain customer interest • Responding to observed or verbal customer buying behaviour. Gather information may include: • Applying or extending questioning techniques to determine customer buying motives • Continuing to use listening skills to determine customer requirements • Interpreting and clarifying verbal and/or non-verbal customer communication cues • Using customer name where possible and appropriate • Presenting sample offers of tourism products and services and noting the response to those suggestions. <i>Demonstrate selling skills</i> may relate to: • Matching Customer Needs To Appropriate Tourism Products And Services • Communicating knowledge of tourism products and services to customer • Explaining the features and selling the benefits of tourism products and services to customers • Involving internal organisational specialists in the interaction • Answering routine customer questions about tourism products and services accurately and honestly or referring to more experienced sales staff. <i>Overcome buying objections</i> may involve: • Identifying and accepting customer objections • Categorising objections into price, time, product and/or service characteristics • Offering solutions according to enterprise policies and individual customer objection
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	• Applying problem-solving to overcome customer objections • Using the 'feel-felt-found' approach. <i>Maximise sales opportunities</i> must include: • Recognising and utilising opportunities for making add-on sales • Advising customer of complimentary tourism products or services according to identified need • Demonstrating the ability to 'up-sell', to use 'suggestive selling' techniques and to use the 'ABC' approach to maximising sales • Complying with enterprise policies in relation to selling. <i>Close the sale</i> must include: • Monitoring, identifying and responding appropriately to customer verbal and non-verbal buying signals • Encouraging customer to make purchase decisions through the use of appropriate and acceptable verbal and non-verbal prompts • Congratulating customer on their selection • Thanking customer for their business • Encouraging customer to return to make further purchases. Assessment Guide The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit: • The enterprise's policies and procedures in regard to promoting and selling tourism products and services • Principles of promotion and selling • Research skills • Communication, negotiation and interpersonal and rapport building skills
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- Tourism product and service knowledge
- Knowledge of target markets for the host enterprise
- Compliance with legal issues of the host country in relation to the promotion and sale of tourism products and services
- Knowledge of differing customer preferences, needs and wants
- Ability to meet and overcome buying objections
- Ability to make suggestions and recommendations in line with identified customer wants, needs and preferences
- Ability to apply a variety of acceptable sales techniques that will achieve a win-win situation without putting pressure on the customer.

Linkages To Other Units

- Access and retrieve computer-based data
- Develop and update local knowledge
- Promote products and services to customers
- Receive and resolve customer complaints
- Gather and present product information
- Maintain a paper-based filing and retrieval system
- Process a financial transaction for services rendered
- Process transactions for purchase of goods and services
- Process financial transactions
- Plan and implement sales activities or campaigns
- Prepare and deliver a presentation
- Create promotional display stand

	• Maintain product information inventory • Plan and implement sales activities • Source and present information. Critical Aspects of Assessment Evidence of the following is essential: • Understanding of host enterprise policies and procedures in regard to promoting and selling tourism products and services • Demonstrated ability to develop product and/or service knowledge for a nominated range of tourism products and services and be able to apply such knowledge in a real or simulated sales situation • Demonstrated ability to develop knowledge about the target markets established by the host enterprise and apply that knowledge in a nominated real or simulated sales or promotion situation • Demonstrated ability to promote a nominated range of tourism products and services internally within the host enterprise • Demonstrated ability to effectively sell a nominated range of tourism products and services to a specified target group in a real or simulated sales situation. Context of Assessment Assessment must ensure: • Actual or simulated workplace application of selling and promotion techniques. Resource Implications Training and assessment must include the use of real tourism products and services involving real or simulated customers.
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Assessment Methods

The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit:

- Observation of practical candidate performance
- Role plays
- Oral and written questions
- Third party reports completed by a supervisor
- Project and assignment work.

Key Competencies in this Unit

Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively

Level 2 = competence to manage tasks

Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating

Key Competencies	Level	Examples
Collecting, organising and analysing information	1	Research, gather and assimilate tourism product and service information
Communicating ideas and information	2	Provide tourism product and service information to customers
Planning and organising activities	2	Prepare sales approaches
Working with others and in teams	1	Include sales specialists in the selling process
Using mathematical ideas and techniques	1	Calculate selling prices for customers as part of the selling/negotiation process

	Solving problems	2	Overcome buying objections
	Using technology	1	Use technology to research and obtain tourism product and service information

Oral questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Promote tourism products and services D2.TCS.CL5.21
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. Why is it important for travel and tourism staff to have extensive knowledge of tourism products and services?	☐	☐
2. What types of product information do you want to gather?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. What is the difference between qualitative and quantitative research?	☐	☐
4. Why is it important to gather customer feedback in a travel and tourism organisation?	☐	☐
5. What are examples of hard copy materials that you can use to share tourism information with colleagues?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. What are examples of influences that can contribute to changes to tourism products and services?	☐	☐
7. What are examples of target markets for a travel and tourism organisation?	☐	☐
8. What is the difference between target markets and niche markets?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
9. What are steps / activities undertaken when creating a promotional strategy?	☐	☐
10. What are the benefits of visiting suppliers when gathering tourism information?	☐	☐
11. Why is it important to understand the demographic characteristics of your target markets?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
12. Why is it important to identify changes in customer preferences, needs, wants and expectations?	☐	☐
13. Why is it important to identify target markets for an organisation?	☐	☐
14. What is the difference between active and reflective listening?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
15. What is the purpose of questioning when identifying customer needs?	☐	☐
16. What are examples of information about repeat customers you would review when trying to determine their future requirements?	☐	☐
17. From a personal point of view, what would be two buying parameters influencing your decision when selecting a holiday destination?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
18. What are two methods to advertise to potential customers?	☐	☐
19. What is the purpose of a 'static in-house' promotion?	☐	☐
20. Explain the concept 'Sell the benefits, not the features.'	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
21. How can you make a good first impression?	☐	☐
22. How can you gather information about customer needs, wants and preferences?	☐	☐
23. What are two examples of basic sales activities undertaken to get customers to purchase?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
24. What are two common buying objections?	☐	☐
25. Provide an example of 'upselling'.	☐	☐
26. How can you ask for a sale?	☐	☐

Written questions

Promote tourism products and services – D2.TCS.CL5.21

Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. What are examples of hard copy publications that can be accessed to gather tourism information?

2. How can you gather tourism product information from customers, colleagues, supervisors and managers?

3. What are other sources of tourism product information?

4. What are the benefits of having tourism product knowledge?

5. What are steps associated with researching tourism information?

6. What is the difference between primary and secondary data?

7. Why is it important to evaluate sources of tourism information?

8. What methods can be used to gather feedback from customers?

9. What are verbal methods that you can use to share tourism information with colleagues?

10. How can you identify demand for individual products and services?

11. What is the purpose of undertaking market segmentation?

12. What is niche marketing?

13. What are different sales methods that can be used as part of a promotional campaign?

14. What are two examples of internal sources used to gather tourism information?

15. For one niche market of your choice, identify their demographic characteristics.

16. What are methods used to identify changes in customer preferences, needs, wants and expectations?

17. What are the benefits of identifying target markets?

18. What are methods used to interpret statements made by customers?

19. What are the types of questions that can be used to identify customer requirements? Provide an example of one type.

20. How can you identify the needs of regular and repeat customers?

21. What are examples of customer buying parameters that influence their decision making process?

22. What are three examples of marketing objectives that an organisation may have?

23. What are examples of static in-house promotions used to entice customers in a store?

24. What are activities undertaken when verbally promoting tourism products and services?

25. What are actions to be performed when acknowledging the customer on arrival?

26. What information would you like to collect when gathering information about customer needs, wants and preferences?

27. Explain the 'ABC' approach to selling. Provide an example.

28. What steps are taken when overcoming buying objections?

29. Provide an example of 'suggestive' selling.

30. What are general rules when closing the sale?

Answers to written questions

Promote tourism products and services – D2.TCS.CL5.21

The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

- 1. What are examples of hard copy publications that can be accessed to gather tourism information?**
 - Local and city newspapers
 - Reading journals, publications and magazines
 - Reading books on the industry sector
 - Reading brochures.
- 2. How can you gather tourism product information from customers, colleagues, supervisors and managers?**
 - Meetings with staff
 - Training and information sessions
 - Briefing notes
 - Direct questions from potential customers
 - Questions from potential customers
 - Points raised by tourism staff requiring clarification
 - Additional information regarding a location which is not detailed in individual company's materials.
- 3. What are other sources of tourism product information?**
 - Customers, colleagues, supervisors and managers
 - Representatives
 - Developing your own industry network
 - Networking with industry colleagues
 - Conferences and seminars
 - Accommodation guides
 - TV programs
 - Personal observations
 - Educationals / familiarisations
 - Product launches
 - Trade shows
 - Local community information.

4. What are the benefits of having tourism product knowledge?

- To demonstrate the professionalism
- To answer routine questions
- Provide destination information and advice
- Provide specific product advice
- To provide additional information
- To advise customers of up-coming events
- To make recommendations and suggestions
- Selling tourism products
- Quote specific individual tourism product prices
- Booking and coordinating services
- Receiving and processing reservations
- Processing financial transactions
- Issuing customer travel documentation
- Issuing itineraries
- Explain the features of the products
- To generate repeat business from customers
- To generate referral business
- To comply with general operational requirements.

5. What are steps associated with researching tourism information?

- Identify the research points
- Collect primary and secondary data
- Identify types of formal and informal research techniques
- Recollection of personal observations
- Accessing internal information
- Accessing external sources of information
- Visits sources of information
- Establishing industry networks.

6. What is the difference between primary and secondary data?

- Primary data – collected for a specific purpose
- Secondary data – generic information.

7. Why is it important to evaluate sources of tourism information?

- Promote legitimate destinations, suppliers, products and services
- Ensure the information provided is a true reflection of what is being promoted
- Ensure customers don't receive materials no longer available
- Materials show current prices
- Help you refer only to current information
- Demonstrates professionalism and attention.

8. What methods can be used to gather feedback from customers?

- Customer comment cards
- Interviews and follow up calls
- Conducting focus group sessions
- Checking internal buying patterns and trends of customers.
- On-line feedback forms
- Testimonials
- General discussion
- Observations.

9. What are verbal methods that you can use to share tourism information with colleagues?

- On a one to one basis
- At staff briefings
- At staff meetings
- Training sessions.

10. How can you identify demand for individual products and services?

- Observation
- Conduct a trial run
- Place an advertisement
- Sales records
- Suppliers
- Industry associations
- Journals and articles
- Other outlets in the organisation
- Competitors
- Feasibility studies.

11. What is the purpose of undertaking market segmentation?

To break down the entire market into groups with similar characteristics; groups with desirable characteristics can then be the target of organisational promotional efforts.

12. What is niche marketing?

Niche marketing is a targeted plan that focuses on one particular section of the market.

13. What are different sales methods that can be used as part of a promotional campaign?

- Personal selling
- Direct marketing
- Sales promotions
- Advertising
- Publicity
- Public relations
- Sponsorship
- Newsletters
- Special Events
- Community Relations
- Media Releases
- On-site tour
- Social media activities.

14. What are two examples of internal sources used to gather tourism information?

- Destination information previously collected
- Customer feedback information
- Automated information systems
- Computerised reservation systems
- Destinations and services inventories.

15. For one niche market of your choice, identify their demographic characteristics.

Answers will vary depending on the niche market selected.

16. What are methods used to identify changes in customer preferences, needs, wants and expectations?

- Undertaking market research activities
- Engaging the services of an external market research company
- Tracking trends and changes in internal sales patterns
- Initiating customer focus groups or similar
- Participating in industry-wide surveys
- Obtaining, reading and understanding research on changes in customer preferences.

17. What are the benefits of identifying target markets?

- Being better able to meet identified need
- Increased, faster and more profitable sales
- More satisfied customers
- Ability to become established as a specialist organisation
- Enhanced levels of repeat and referral business
- Being able to get to know target market better
- Reducing the likelihood of competitors.

18. What are methods used to interpret statements made by customers?

- Listening to verbal descriptions, aspirations and requests
- Paying attention to non-verbal cues that accompany verbal language
- Reading material supplied by the customer
- Reading 'between the lines'
- Applying reflective and active listening techniques.

19. What are the types of questions that can be used to identify customer requirements? Provide an example of one type.

- Open questions
- Clarifying questions
- Leading questions
- Closed questions.

20. How can you identify the needs of regular and repeat customers?

- Through using your memory
- By using the in-house database
- Speaking to other staff who have dealt with them
- Seeking information from the customer about their travel and tourism experiences
- Reviewing client history files
- Reviewing customer complaints and compliments
- Reviewing records and databases.

21. What are examples of customer buying parameters that influence their decision making process?

- Timing
- Budget
- Individual needs, wants and preferences for suppliers, providers and carriers
- Meeting disabled needs
- Dietary requirements.

22. What are three examples of marketing objectives that an organisation may have?

- To reinforce, continue or extend previous promotions of an existing packages
- To introduce a new package to the marketplace
- To notify customers that an existing package has been revised and altered in some way
- To meet direct competition
- To resurrect flagging sales
- To support a promotion or sale
- To build a larger customer database
- To fill an empty space in the promotion calendar or on the floor
- To improve profitability
- To capture a bigger market share
- To achieve a profit of X %
- To generate new clients
- Increased brand awareness in the market place
- Reinforcing or cementing success of organisation.

23. What are examples of static in-house promotions used to entice customers in a store?

- Window and counter displays including pricing tickets and itineraries
- Use of point-of-sale material provided by suppliers, providers and carriers
- Advertising material that promotes nominated tourism products or services
- Informational and other print-based materials including posters
- Use of appropriate props to support, extend and highlight the tourism product and/or service being promoted
- Integration with external media and other campaigns.

24. What are activities undertaken when verbally promoting tourism products and services?

- Honesty and accuracy in descriptions
- Adherence to enterprise policies and procedures governing selling
- Using appropriate questioning and listening techniques
- Using descriptive phrases
- Selling the benefits and not the features
- Comparison of various tourism products and services
- Making suggestions and recommendations
- Meeting identified customer need
- Using brochures and marketing materials to supplement and illustrate the verbal explanation.

25. What are actions to be performed when acknowledging the customer on arrival?

- Be genuine in the greeting or approach you make
- Match the non-verbal signals with the words
- Ensure the approach is timely
- Smile
- Be prepared to allow the customer to help themselves if this is what they indicate
- Don't hover
- Reply to the customer's response
- Making eye contact with customers to acknowledge their presence
- Provide a non-verbal signal that you are available whenever they need your help
- Speaking to the customer
- Making a verbal offer of assistance
- Establish rapport
- Use the customer's name
- Give the customer your undivided attention
- Be enthusiastic
- Be the customer's solution
- Go the extra distance.

26. What information would you like to collect when gathering information about customer needs, wants and preferences?

Answers will vary.

27. Explain the 'ABC' approach to selling. Provide an example.

- 'A' stands for Automatic
- 'B' stands for Bettered
- 'C' stands for Created.

28. What steps are taken when overcoming buying objections?

- Identifying and accepting customer objections
- Categorising objections into price, time, product/service characteristics
- Offering solutions according to enterprise policies
- Applying problem solving to overcome customer objections
- Using the 'feel-felt-found' approach.

29. Provide an example of 'suggestive' selling.

Answers will vary.

30. What are general rules when closing the sale?

- Expect to make the sale
- Stay focused
- Accept it is the customer's decision to buy
- The sale must be mutually beneficial
- No-one sells every time
- Use verbal and non-verbal prompts
- Ask for the sale.

Observation checklist

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Promote tourism products and services D2.TCS.CL5.21
Dates of observation	
Instructions	- Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: - Develop tourism produce and services knowledge - Develop tourism market knowledge - Identify individual customer needs - Promote tourism products and services - Apply selling skills - Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken - Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise - Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 1: Develop tourism produce and services knowledge		
Identify opportunities to develop tourism product and service knowledge	☐	☐
Describe the benefits of staff having high levels of product and service knowledge	☐	☐
Apply formal and informal research techniques to gain product and service knowledge	☐	☐
Seek customer feedback to supplement product and service knowledge	☐	☐
Share product and service knowledge with other relevant internal personnel	☐	☐
Contribute to changes to tourism products, services and service standards to meet identified customer need	☐	☐

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 2: Develop tourism market knowledge		
Explain the concept of target markets	☐	☐
Define the concept of niche markets	☐	☐
Describe how promotions and offers may vary to suit differing target markets	☐	☐
Identify sources of information about enterprise-specific target markets	☐	☐
Describe the demographic characteristics of enterprise target markets	☐	☐
Initiate action to identify changes in customer preferences, needs, wants and expectations	☐	☐
Explain the benefits of using target markets within an organisation	☐	☐
Element 3: Identify individual customer needs		
Interpret statements made by customers	☐	☐
Ask questions to determine requirements	☐	☐
Consider the buying history of the customer	☐	☐
Establish buying parameters	☐	☐
Element 4: Promote tourism products and services		
Describe promotional initiatives that may be used to promote tourism products	☐	☐
Demonstrate how to develop and produce a static in-house promotion	☐	☐
Verbally promote tourism products and/or services to customers	☐	☐

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 5: Apply selling skills		
Approach the customer in a sales environment	☐	☐
Gather information about customer needs, wants and preferences	☐	☐
Demonstrate selling skills	☐	☐
Overcome buying objections	☐	☐
Maximise sales opportunities within a buying situation	☐	☐
Close the sale	☐	☐
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor

Strengths:

Improvements needed:

General comments:

Candidate signature

Date

Assessor signature

Date

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no:	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other Please specify: _____ Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest]		
Unit of competency:	Promote tourism products and services D2.TCS.CL5.21		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			
Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? (tick the correct response]	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 1: Develop tourism produce and services knowledge			
Identify opportunities to develop tourism product and service knowledge	☐	☐	☐
Describe the benefits of staff having high levels of product and service knowledge	☐	☐	☐
Apply formal and informal research techniques to gain product and service knowledge	☐	☐	☐
Seek customer feedback to supplement product and service knowledge	☐	☐	☐
Share product and service knowledge with other relevant internal personnel	☐	☐	☐
Contribute to changes to tourism products, services and service standards to meet identified customer need	☐	☐	☐

Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response)</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 2: Develop tourism market knowledge			
Explain the concept of target markets	☐	☐	☐
Define the concept of niche markets	☐	☐	☐
Describe how promotions and offers may vary to suit differing target markets	☐	☐	☐
Identify sources of information about enterprise-specific target markets	☐	☐	☐
Describe the demographic characteristics of enterprise target markets	☐	☐	☐
Initiate action to identify changes in customer preferences, needs, wants and expectations	☐	☐	☐
Explain the benefits of using target markets within an organisation	☐	☐	☐
Element 3: Identify individual customer needs			
Interpret statements made by customers	☐	☐	☐
Ask questions to determine requirements	☐	☐	☐
Consider the buying history of the customer	☐	☐	☐
Establish buying parameters	☐	☐	☐
Element 4: Promote tourism products and services			
Describe promotional initiatives that may be used to promote tourism products	☐	☐	☐
Demonstrate how to develop and produce a static in-house promotion	☐	☐	☐
Verbally promote tourism products and/or services to customers	☐	☐	☐

Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response)</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 5: Apply selling skills			
Approach the customer in a sales environment	☐	☐	☐
Gather information about customer needs, wants and preferences	☐	☐	☐
Demonstrate selling skills	☐	☐	☐
Overcome buying objections	☐	☐	☐
Maximise sales opportunities within a buying situation	☐	☐	☐
Close the sale	☐	☐	☐

Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:

Third party signature:

Date:

Send to:

Competency recording sheet

Name of Student		
Name of Assessor/s		
Unit of Competency	Promote tourism products and services	D2.TCS.CL5.21
Date assessment commenced		
Date assessment finalised		
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)	
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)		
Comments/observations by assessor/s		

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Develop tourism produce and services knowledge						
Identify opportunities to develop tourism product and service knowledge						
Describe the benefits of staff having high levels of product and service knowledge						
Apply formal and informal research techniques to gain product and service knowledge						
Seek customer feedback to supplement product and service knowledge						
Share product and service knowledge with other relevant internal personnel						
Contribute to changes to tourism products, services and service standards to meet identified customer need						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 2: Develop tourism market knowledge						
Explain the concept of target markets						
Define the concept of niche markets						
Describe how promotions and offers may vary to suit differing target markets						
Identify sources of information about enterprise-specific target markets						
Describe the demographic characteristics of enterprise target markets						
Initiate action to identify changes in customer preferences, needs, wants and expectations						
Explain the benefits of using target markets within an organisation						
Element 3: Identify individual customer needs						
Interpret statements made by customers						
Ask questions to determine requirements						
Consider the buying history of the customer						
Establish buying parameters						

Element & Performance Criteria		Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 4: Promote tourism products and services							
Describe promotional initiatives that may be used to promote tourism products							
Demonstrate how to develop and produce a static in-house promotion							
Verbally promote tourism products and/or services to customers							
Element 5: Apply selling skills							
Approach the customer in a sales environment							
Gather information about customer needs, wants and preferences							
Demonstrate selling skills							
Overcome buying objections							
Maximise sales opportunities within a buying situation							
Close the sale							
Candidate signature:				Date:			
Assessor signature:				Date:			

